

NATIONAL LOUIS UNIVERSITY

Informed Consent to Participate in Research

Pedagogical Friction in the Age of Generative AI and Tertiary Algorithmicity

Anonymous online survey — displayed as the first screen of the survey

Study period: 09-2026 to 02-2027

Who is doing this study

My name is Micah J. Miner, and I am a doctoral candidate in the Curriculum, Advocacy, and Policy program at National Louis University. I am asking you to participate in this study, “Pedagogical Friction in the Age of Generative AI and Tertiary Algorithmicity,” occurring from 09-2026 to 02-2027. I am conducting this study as part of my dissertation under the supervision of Dr. Terri Jo Smith. I also work as a school district technology administrator in Illinois. That role is separate from this study, and this study is not conducted on behalf of any school district, company, or product.

Why this study is being done

This survey asks K–12 educators and school system leaders how generative AI is affecting the effortful parts of learning in their schools, and what policy, assessment, professional learning, and leadership conditions help or hinder their response. The goal is to help school systems write AI guidance grounded in reported practice.

Who can take part

You may take part if you are 18 years of age or older and you currently work in a K–12 school or district as a classroom-facing educator, a building administrator, or a district or system leader. Employees of Beach Park Community Consolidated School District 3 are not eligible for this study. You are also not eligible if the researcher holds supervisory or evaluative authority over you or if you and the researcher currently have or are discussing a consulting, contracting, or paid speaking arrangement.

What you will be asked to do

You will complete one online survey taking about 10 to 12 minutes depending on your role path. Please complete this survey only once. The form contains 27 numbered questions. It includes background questions, rating-scale statements, two open-response questions, and a role-specific section. Questions 1, 2, and 22 are required for consent and role routing; all other substantive questions may be skipped.

Risks and benefits

The risk to you is no greater than that of everyday life. Because the survey is anonymous, the risk of disclosure is low. There is no guaranteed direct benefit to you. The broader benefit is better-grounded AI guidance for schools.

How your information will be kept confidential

This survey is administered in Microsoft Forms and is configured to accept responses without requiring you to sign in. Names and email addresses are not recorded with anonymous responses. The response data available to the researcher will include a response ID, start and completion times, and your survey answers, but will not include a respondent IP-address field.

Please do not type the names of students, colleagues, schools, or districts into the open-response boxes. If any such name appears, I will remove it before analysis.

Responses are exported from Microsoft Forms and stored in encrypted, access-controlled storage in my NLU-managed OneDrive account. I am the only person with routine access. A response ID and start and completion times are survey records, but they do not provide the researcher with your name or email address. Aggregated results and de-identified quotations from open responses may appear in the dissertation and in later publications or presentations. Survey data are kept for at least three years after the study closes.

Because the survey is anonymous, I cannot locate and delete your individual responses once you submit them. If you want to withdraw, close the survey before you submit.

Your participation is voluntary

Taking part is entirely your choice. You may skip any question except Questions 1, 2, and 22, which are needed for consent and correct role routing, and you may close the survey at any point before submitting. You will not be paid. Declining or withdrawing will not affect your employment, professional standing, or relationship with the researcher.

Sharing the results

When the study is finished, I will send a short plain-language summary of the findings to any participant who asks for one. The completed dissertation will be available through National Louis University, and I will provide a link on request.

Whom to contact

If you have questions about this study, contact the researcher:

Micah J. Miner, doctoral candidate, National College of Education, National Louis University, 122 South Michigan Avenue, Chicago, IL 60603. Email: mminer1@my.nl.edu. Phone: 312-504-4193.

You may also contact the faculty member supervising this study:

Dr. Terri Jo Smith, Committee Chair, National Louis University, 122 South Michigan Avenue, Chicago, IL 60603. Email: TJSmith@nl.edu. Phone: 224-233-2315.

If you have any concerns or questions before or during participation that have not been addressed by the researcher, you may contact the Chairs of National Louis University's Institutional Research Board:

Dr. Shaunti Knauth; email: Shaunti.Knauth@nl.edu; phone: (312) 261-3526; or Dr. Carla L. Sparks; email: CSparks3@nl.edu; phone: (813) 928-6889. IRB Chairs are located at National Louis University, 122 South Michigan Avenue, Chicago, IL.

Statement of consent

Please print or save a copy of this consent information for your records before selecting a response.

1. ELECTRONIC CONSENT: Please select your choice below. Selecting "I agree to participate" indicates that

- You have read the above information
- You voluntarily agree to participate
- You are 18 years of age or older

☐ I agree to participate

☐ I do not agree (Exit survey)